The 6:15

MONDAY · OCTOBER 12, 2026 NO. 25

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Today	Columbus Day/Indigenous Peoples' Day: bond market, Fed and banks closed; NYSE/Nasdaq trade normal hours. Knicks host Minnesota, MSG, 7:30p, preseason.
Tue 10/13	Q3 bank earnings open: JPMorgan (~$5.90–5.94 cons. EPS), Goldman Sachs ($15.39), Citigroup ($2.66) **[Street estimates, not a wire survey]**; Wells Fargo also reportedly reports today, ~7a **[timing unconfirmed — reverses issue No. 24's read]**; Johnson & Johnson Q3, 8:30a call.
Wed 10/14, 8:30a	September CPI (BLS) — Cleveland Fed nowcast 3.60% headline / 2.39% core **[nowcast, not consensus]**.
Thu 10/15, 8:30a	September PPI, advance retail sales, jobless claims, Philly Fed index.
Fri 10/16	Import/export prices, industrial production & capacity utilization.

Standing: FOMC Oct. 27–28; OPEC+ next meets Nov. 1; Dec. 11 CR and Jan. 10 US-China truce unchanged [continuity]; midterms Nov. 3. No frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — fourth straight issue skipping this sub-bullet.

METRICS · ET — BOND MARKET CLOSED TODAY FOR COLUMBUS DAY

Oil	Brent $104.72 Fri. settle (+0.42%) / WTI $91.85 Fri. settle (+0.39%), spread ~$12.87 (EnergyNow); Mon. pre-mkt ~6a: Brent easing toward ~$103, WTI futures 92.59 (+0.81% intraday, Yahoo) — pullback tracks Trump's claim Russia/Ukraine agreed to spare each other's energy grids **[claim, not confirmed by Moscow or Kyiv]**.
Rates/$	10Y 5.24% (Fri. close, unchanged — desks shut today); 30Y 5.60%, 13-wk bill 4.057% [continuity]; 2Y **not confirmed this run** [same gap as issue No.

	24]; DXY **not confirmed this run** [conflicting, stale quotes].
Equities/vol	S&P fut. 7,867.75 (+0.10%), Nasdaq fut. 31,084.75 (-0.08%), Dow fut. 51,991 (+0.13%), Russell 2000 fut. 2,823.70 (+0.06%) ~6a; VIX 15.47 (+4.25%); Fri. cash: S&P 7,811.54 (+0.59%), Nasdaq Comp. 27,366.17 (+0.64%) [continuity].
Gold/gas/Asia-Eu	Gold (Dec. fut.) $4,197.80 (-0.44%) pre-mkt; AAA nat'l gas $4.3556/gal today, down from $4.3669 Fri.; Tokyo closed (Health-Sports Day, last close Fri. 69,031); Hang Seng ~24,200 (+0.1%), Shanghai ~3,808 (-0.12%); FTSE ~10,610 (+0.55%), DAX ~25,235 (+0.6%) mid-morning London, intraday.

Yahoo/CNBC futures ticks and Friday ICE/NYMEX settlements are the sources of record used above; no two sources agreed closely enough on DXY or Asia/Europe levels to treat any single figure as settled.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Transits	18 on Oct. 7 (Windward, ~20% of ~88/day pre-crisis); 2 on Oct. 10, 10.1/day 7-day avg (separate AIS tracker, ~12% of baseline); 7 vessels Oct. 6 (Reuters/Kpler). Not averaged or differenced — see note.
Strikes	≥12 vessels struck wk. ended Oct. 5, worst since the war began Feb. 28 (Al Jazeera). New: drone strike on tanker MT Petro Dolphin, 2 Indian seafarers missing **[NEW, straits.live, single-sourced]**; Iran state media claims a separate supertanker struck a mine **[unconfirmed]**; NY Post reports a US strike on an unnamed vessel it says was running the blockade **[NEW, unconfirmed, single-sourced]**.
Mines/status	US military says primary transit lanes cleared of mines as of Oct. 8 (thehormuzstrait.com) **[single-sourced]**; straits.live still frames the strait "effectively closed" to commercial shipping.
War-risk	~$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~30x pre-crisis — figure now ~18 days stale, not refreshed this run [continuity].

Windward, the unnamed AIS tracker, and Kpler/Reuters count transits over different windows with different dark-tanker handling; Al Jazeera's and CNBC's strike tallies likely

overlap but aren't reconciled to the same days. Figures are reported side by side here, never averaged or differenced.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7 [continuity].
Knicks	0-2 preseason after 111-109 loss to Washington Oct. 8 at MSG; host Minnesota tonight, 7:30p, MSG — result not in as of press time.
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 Saturday at Ryan Field, Homecoming **[single-sourced]**.

LEAD

RIYADH AIRPORT HIT

A Houthi strike kills 12 at Saudi Arabia's main airport — opening a second front that could outrun Trump's own no-strike pledge on Iran

Saudi Arabia said Saturday that a Houthi strike on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh killed at least 12 people and wounded roughly 300, the third strike on the airport that week and the deadliest Houthi attack on Saudi soil since the Gulf war widened into the strait. [fact] The dead included four Saudis, two Bangladeshis, and nationals of the US, Jordan, Palestine, Syria, Sudan and Egypt, per Saudi civil-aviation officials; the airport closed through at least Sunday, canceling more than 600 flights, and a second strike Sunday reportedly set a fire in Terminal 4. [fact] The Saudi-led coalition called it "a full-fledged war crime" and vowed to respond; the UN secretary-general and Qatar condemned the attack. [fact] Trump said he is considering joining Saudi strikes on Houthi targets in Yemen — a notable statement given that, two days earlier, he had pledged no US strikes on Iran itself before the Nov. 3 midterms. [fact]

The mechanism matters because the Houthi theater and the Iran theater are legally and politically distinct even though Tehran arms and directs the Houthis. Trump's Wednesday pledge — "we will not be attacking Iran at any time prior to the Midterm Elections" — covered strikes on Iran proper; it said nothing about Yemen, and the naval blockade of Iranian ports stays in place regardless. [fact] That leaves Washington a theater in which it can escalate, visibly, without technically breaking a promise voters have been told about — and a Saudi government that has just taken the worst civilian casualties of the war on its own soil, with its flagship international airport closed, has every incentive to push the US toward exactly that. [read] The Atlantic's report that the White House had separately asked the Pentagon to develop strike options against Iran before the midterms — reported before Trump's pledge — suggests the administration was already weighing readiness on the Iran track; a parallel buildup toward Houthi strikes would run on its own clock. [fact, flag: single-sourced via The Atlantic]

Markets read this as adjacent to, not central to, the oil story this morning. Brent eased toward $103 and WTI toward the low $90s in early Monday trading — a pullback, not a spike — because Trump is simultaneously claiming Russia and Ukraine have agreed to stop hitting each other's energy infrastructure, which would ease a separate source of diesel-supply strain. [fact/flag: Trump's claim is not confirmed by Moscow or Kyiv as of this run, consistent with the same claim's unconfirmed status when Trump first made it in mid-September] Oil's muted reaction to a mass-casualty strike on a G20 nation's capital airport is the tell: traders are treating the Houthi-Saudi front as adding to an already-priced-in regional risk premium rather than as a new shock, even as the Hormuz transit collapse (as

low as 12% of the pre-crisis baseline by one count) and the near-daily tanker strikes continue underneath it. [read]

There is also a read on Tehran's own incentives worth stating explicitly rather than folding into the fact pattern above. Iran International reports that Trump's no-strike pledge has prompted some Iranian hardliners to frame the period before Nov. 3 as "three golden weeks" — a window to act against US and allied interests precisely because Washington has taken direct strikes on Iran off the table until the vote. [fact, flag: single-sourced via Iran International, a Persian-language outlet critical of the Iranian government] That framing doesn't prove the Houthi attack on Riyadh was coordinated with or encouraged by Tehran — the Houthis have their own campaign logic tied to the Hormuz war and to Saudi-led coalition operations in Yemen — but it does mean the "no strikes on Iran" pledge, read in Tehran by its harder factions, may function less as de-escalation and more as a dare. [read] Iranian President Pezeshkian calling negotiations with Washington "futile" earlier the same week cuts the same way. [fact]

Watch: whether Trump actually authorizes US strikes on Houthi targets, which would be the first direct US military action against Yemen's Houthis since the broader Iran war began Feb. 28; whether Riyadh's own retaliation is independent of Washington; and whether a Houthi-Saudi escalation track becomes the de facto workaround for the administration's own self-imposed restraint on Iran before Nov. 3. The carrier buildup — a third US carrier group now en route, expected in theater by late November per the most recent WSJ-sourced reporting — continues on its own timeline either way. [fact]

POLITICS

Midterm positioning continues on the terms set in prior issues: polling averages still point to Democrats retaking the House, with the Iran war, immigration, tariffs and gas prices cited as the dominant voter concerns, and the president's approval at record lows by the same polling [continuity, no new figures this run]. Vice President Vance has framed affordability as the deciding issue after GOP losses in Virginia and New Jersey's off-year races. [fact] Election Day is Nov. 3 — three weeks out, and now also the explicit deadline Trump has attached to his own restraint on Iran, which the Lead covers. That overlap is itself a political fact worth naming plainly: a sitting president has tied a foreign-policy commitment directly to an election date, which gives any pre-election escalation — the Houthi-Saudi track chief among them — a domestic political reading whether or not that is the intent. [read] Nothing new on the Texas congressional-map litigation was located this run; the case remains at the Supreme Court on Justice Alito's administrative stay of the panel ruling that blocked the 2025 map, a status unchanged since last tracked. **[continuity, stale]**

ECONOMICS

The week's single most consequential data point for the Fed arrives Wednesday: September CPI at 8:30a. The Cleveland Fed's nowcast puts headline at 3.60% y/y and core at 2.39% — both above target and, if they print close to that, likely to harden the case against another cut at the Oct. 27–28 FOMC meeting. [fact, nowcast not consensus] That meeting follows a September hike, not a cut: the Fed raised its target range 25bp to 3.75%–4.00% that month, citing persistently elevated inflation — worth flagging because it cuts against a market narrative that had been pricing steady easing. [fact] PPI, retail sales, jobless claims and the Philly Fed index follow

Thursday; import/export prices and industrial production close out the week Friday. A Reuters poll of strategists published Oct. 7 put the 2-year Treasury yield at 4.70%, 4.60% and 4.25% over three, six and twelve months respectively — a forecast, not a spot level, and one that implies the street expects cuts to resume once the current inflation impulse (tariff pass-through, oil-driven energy costs from the Hormuz disruption) fades. [fact/flag: forecast, not observed] Today's Columbus Day holiday means no cash Treasury market and no new 2-year print to test that view against; trading resumes Tuesday.

BUSINESS

Third-quarter earnings season opens in earnest Tuesday. JPMorgan, Goldman Sachs and Citigroup are all slated to report before Tuesday's open, with Street consensus near $5.90–5.94 EPS on roughly $51.5B revenue for JPMorgan, $15.39 EPS on $17.42B revenue for Goldman (versus $12.25 a year ago), and $2.66 EPS on $23.7B revenue for Citigroup. [fact, flag: single/mixed-sourced estimates, not a wire survey] Wells Fargo is also reportedly reporting Tuesday around 7a, with a Zacks estimate near $1.85 EPS on $22.15B revenue (+3.3% y/y) — a reversal from issue No. 24's read, which had Wells Fargo confirmed for Tuesday and JPMorgan's date unconfirmed; treat both dates as provisional until the banks' own IR calendars are checked this week. [flag] Johnson & Johnson reports Tuesday as well, with an 8:30a investor call, making it the earliest S&P 500 industrial name of the season. No notable earnings were scheduled for today, Columbus Day. [fact]

Context for how banks' results will be read: one pre-market breakdown this morning put the S&P 500 up roughly 13.5% year to

date, against a non-AI "old economy" index up only about 5.5% and Europe's STOXX 600 up roughly 5.6% over the same stretch. [fact, flag: single-sourced breakdown, methodology for the "old economy" index not independently verified this run] If that breadth gap holds, bank earnings matter less for where the index goes than for whether credit quality and loan growth — away from the AI capex story — hold up; a soft read from JPMorgan, Goldman or Citi on consumer or commercial credit would be a different kind of signal than another hyperscaler capex beat.

The carrier buildup the Lead references continues on a timeline separate from this weekend's Houthi escalation: the USS Theodore Roosevelt strike group left San Diego Sept. 27 to relieve the Japan-based USS George Washington, with Carrier Air Wing 11 and the USS Makin Island amphibious group (13th Marine Expeditionary Unit, 2,000-plus Marines) accompanying it. [fact] The most recent reporting — a WSJ-sourced account — puts full arrival in theater at late November, which would put three US carriers in the Middle East simultaneously for the first time since April and, before that, since 2003; no fresher reporting on the earlier, AP-sourced "end of October" estimate from issue No. 24 was located this run, so the divergence between the two timelines stands unresolved. [fact/flag] OPEC+'s Nov. 1 meeting and its decision to hold November output flat at 31.01mn b/d remain the operative supply-side facts from issue No. 24; no new OPEC+ news was found this run. [continuity]

In a wrinkle that cuts against Riyadh-Washington alignment on the Houthis, Iran separately contacted Saudi Arabia in the wake of the airport attack and reportedly offered to help broker talks between Riyadh and the Houthi movement it arms. [fact, flag: single-sourced] Read at face value, that is Tehran positioning itself as indispensable mediator for a crisis caused by its own proxy — a posture Saudi officials have not publicly endorsed. [read] It sits alongside Windward's reporting that the IRGC and allied units have widened their stated targeting criteria to any vessel taking what they deem an "unauthorized" route through the wider Gulf, not just the strait itself — language that ties directly to the Fujairah- and Madinat ash Shamal-area incidents flagged in issue No. 24 and suggests the

conflict's geographic footprint, not just its intensity, is still expanding. [fact, continuity on the underlying Windward report]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Houthi-Saudi story in the Lead, the diplomatic track between Washington and Tehran shows no confirmed movement since issue No. 24: Foreign Minister Araghchi said Sept. 29 that he expected a "formal US answer" via Qatari mediators "on Tuesday" to Iran's seven-day Hormuz-reopening proposal, but no reporting located this run confirms whether that answer arrived, in either direction. [flag: gap, not filled from memory] Trump has separately said he rejected an earlier iteration of Iran's proposal as unacceptable, and Araghchi has said Tehran made no concessions — the same impasse (Washington wants the nuclear program addressed now, Tehran wants it deferred) that has held since issue No. 23. [continuity]

In the strait itself, the pattern described on the Board — collapsed transit counts, near-daily strikes, dueling and unconfirmed claims about Saturday's and Sunday's incidents — continues without resolution. The US military's claim of clearing mines from the primary transit lanes (Oct. 8, single-sourced) sits uneasily next to straits.live's continued "effectively closed" framing and the fresh Petro Dolphin strike reported as this issue went to press; none of these trackers agree with each other closely enough to average, and this issue doesn't attempt to. **[flag]**

Coverage itself is split on direction. Maritime Executive's framing — "Iran's grip loosens" — points to the mine-clearing claim and the lower, Windward-tracked strike count as evidence Tehran's chokehold is weakening; Al Jazeera's framing — "efforts to end war

on Iran stall" — points to the unresolved diplomatic track and the Petro Dolphin strike as evidence it isn't. [read; both are interpretive framings layered on overlapping but not identical facts] Both can be true in different senses: transit volume and mine risk may be improving in the lanes the US Navy actively escorts, while the attack surface — now extending to Fujairah, Madinat ash Shamal, and, per the Lead, Saudi civil aviation — keeps widening. Nothing in this run's reporting resolves which trend dominates.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated in the ALDS Oct. 7 [continuity].
Knicks	0-2 preseason; lost 111-109 to Washington Oct. 8 at MSG; host Minnesota tonight, 7:30p, MSG — result not in.
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 Saturday, Homecoming, Ryan Field; moves to 4-1 overall (prior record 3-1, plus this win) **[single-sourced on the final score]**.

Continuity. Yankees and OPEC+ output carried forward unchanged from issue No. 24. The Texas redistricting case is noted but stale (last tracked status, no October update found). Technology is cut entirely — no frontier AI release, rocket launch, VC mega-round, or dated tech-sector news verified this run, the fourth straight issue skipping it rather than padding it. The Iran-US "definitive response" thread from issue No. 24 has no confirmed update either way this run and is flagged as a gap, not resolved.

Unverified figures are marked in red. The Riyadh airport death/injury toll, the Petro Dolphin strike, the NY Post US-strike report, Iran's mine claim, the mine-clearing claim, all Hormuz transit/war-risk figures, DXY, the 2-year Treasury yield, and the AP-sourced late-October carrier timeline (unrefreshed this run) are flagged above. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.